



Ultrasound in VR

There is a 3D ultrasound that can scan and generate 3D models of unborn babies that can be viewed in VR. <http://dgit.in/UnbornVR>



From Titan to Loon

Alphabet is shifting their Titan team to Projects Loon and Wing, as UAV internet is proving too complex. <http://dgit.in/TitanXLoon>

LG

Like others featured in this list, LG Electronics didn't really start with its current name. It used to be Goldstar in 1958 in the aftermath of the Korean War. At least, it started off with the goal to build electronic devices. A sister company was known as 'Lak-Hui'



LG started off as GoldStar

(which is pronounced as Lucky) and that was where Lucky Goldstar originates from. Goldstar officially adopted the LG name and logo in 1995 and that is also currently used for the tagline 'Life's Good'.

Sony

Sony was originally founded as Tokyo Tsushin Kogyo K.K (meaning Tokyo Telecommunications Engineering Corporation) or Totsuko in short. After multiple successful products they decided to go global. At this point they strongly considered keeping their initials as the global brand name but that clashed with the railway company Tokyo Kyuko. Carrying forward the acronym was also rejected because during a visit to the United States, one of the founders Akio Morita discovered the Americans found 'Totsuko' quite hard to produce. Ultimately, the name



Imagine the Totsuko PlayStation?

Sony was chosen as a mix of two words - 'Sonus', the Latin word that is the root for sonic and sound and 'Sonny', a common American slang from that time that was used to call a boy. Also, 'sonny boy' was a popular loan word being used in Japanese around that time that denoted presentable smart young men, which the founders considered themselves to be!

Nintendo

Brace yourselves for this one because it's going to get complicated in here. Initially, Nintendo Koppai was founded to make and sell playing cards and was looking to start a new line for which it settled on the name Tengu. Tengu is a mythological Japanese folklore character depicted with a large nose. Still here? Good. The cards were known by the word 'hana' which meant nose and coincidentally, also meant flower. So these cards came to be known as hanafuda cards and Hanafuda came to be the popular card game. Now, Nintendo in Kanji can mean 'the temple of free hanafuda' or 'the company that is allowed to make (or sell) hanafuda'. The rest is history.

Amazon

Jeff Bezos initially wanted to call his new website Cadabra, as in abracadabra because he wanted the site to work so fast and easy that people would want to associate it with magic. In fact, the company was registered with this very name in 1994, but eventually a year later, the site went live with the name Amazon, borrowed from the largest river in the world (by discharge of water). That clearly stated the ambitions Bezos had for the website. So why was Cadabra dropped? Because Bezos eventually realised that it sounded too similar to cadaver.

Google

Oh, Cmon! You probably know this already! Google is a deliberate misspelling of the word Googol that represents the number 10^{100} , to convey the large amount of data that the founders Sergey Brin and Larry Page wanted to make available. But what isn't entirely popular knowledge is that the company had the initial nickname 'BackRub'. Imagine - 'I just Back-Rubbed it'. *silent shudder*

Mozilla

Back in 1994, a team at Netscape held a meeting to ideate on a new browser to take on NCSA's Mosaic browser. They wanted to build something that would crush the competition. Enter Godzilla,



Makes more sense, eh?

and combined with Mosaic they arrived at the current day name of Mozilla.

Wikipedia

Wikipedia's arrival at its name almost rivals Nintendo's. It essentially started as Nupedia but due to a drastically slow pace of content creation (12 pages in the first year), they looked elsewhere for inspiration. The main idea that they agreed upon was Ward Cunningham's WikiWikiWeb (which was one of the first user editable websites) to nurture interest in Nupedia by allowing people to edit the content. But the word Wiki



All aboard the Wiki Wiki bus!

goes beyond that. Ward Cunningham himself arrived at the name after landing at Honolulu airport and being told to board the WikiWiki Shuttle, where Wiki is Hawaiian for fast.

Asus

Another simple one on the list, Asus is inspired from Pegasus. According to the company's own explanation it "embodies the strength, purity, and adventurous spirit of this fantastic creature, and soars to new heights with each new product it creates." Much explanation, very logical.

Skype

With Skype, it's another classic case of settling for a name after the original